

Fat Loss Guide

Core Principle

Fat loss requires a sustained calorie deficit - consuming fewer calories than the body expends (TDEE). No food, exercise, or supplement bypasses this energy balance requirement.

A moderate deficit of 300-500 kcal/day (or ~15-20% below TDEE) is generally sustainable and preserves more lean mass than aggressive deficits.

Training for Fat Loss

Resistance training 3-5x/week preserves muscle mass during a deficit, which keeps metabolic rate higher and improves body composition outcomes versus cardio alone.

Add 2-4 cardio sessions per week (mix of steady-state and intervals) to increase total energy expenditure without excessive fatigue.

Daily step count (e.g., 8,000-10,000 steps) is an easy, low-fatigue lever for increasing non-exercise activity thermogenesis (NEAT).

Nutrition Levers

Lever	How it Helps
High protein (1.8-2.2 g/kg)	Preserves muscle, highest satiety per calorie
Fiber-rich vegetables/fruit	Adds volume and satiety at low calorie cost
Minimizing liquid calories	Easy way to reduce intake without feeling deprived
Consistent meal structure	Reduces impulsive snacking and decision fatigue

Common Pitfalls

Excessively aggressive deficits (>25-30% below TDEE) often cause muscle loss, low energy, and poor training performance.

Underestimating intake: tracking food for at least a few weeks improves awareness of true calorie intake.

Expecting linear progress: weight fluctuates day to day from water and digestion; judge trends over 1-2 week averages, not single readings.

Realistic Rate of Loss

A commonly cited sustainable rate is roughly 0.5-1% of bodyweight per week. Faster loss increases risk of muscle loss and rebound weight gain.